STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-5210
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **03/10/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT PRE-EMPLOYMENT BACKGROUND INVESTIGATION	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for conducting pre-employment background investigations.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall conduct pre-employment background investigations on all potential employees. No offer of employment shall be made until a thorough background investigation is completed. Information obtained during the investigation shall be held in strict confidence and only released to Sheriff's Office personnel directly involved in the pre-employment process.

III. Procedures for Sworn Applicants: Steps A. through J. shall be completed prior to Merit Commission Certification of the hiring list. The certified list containing three (3) candidates standing highest on the eligibility list for the position to be filled shall be forwarded to the Sheriff and he shall appoint one (1) of the three (3) persons certified.

A. Sworn Posting: The Sheriff's Office shall post for entry level deputy positions in electronic and paper media of general circulation in Sarpy County and applications will be collected by Sarpy County Human Resources and eligible applicant names will be forward to the Sheriff's Office
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B. Application Review: The Training Sergeant shall send out an in-depth application to eligible applicants. The Training Sergeant shall review all applications received by the pre-determined deadline and assess a point value to items using an objective pre-set scale. Any applicant scoring more than thirty (30) shall be removed from consideration for employment in a sworn capacity.

C. Written Examination: Applicants making it past the application review shall be invited to the written examination. The written examination consists of the

T.A.B.E. (if applicable) and a test that numerically ranks applicants approved by the Merit Commission.

D. **Initial Interview:** A initial interview shall be completed for each potential sworn employee. The initial interview shall be scheduled by the Training Sergeant and take place prior to the background investigation and may include the Administration Captain, Professional Standards Lieutenant, Training Sergeant, and Professional Standards Deputy.

E. **Fitness Test:** Applicants who successfully complete the Initial Interview will be invited to the Cooper Standard Fitness Test. Applicants must score a combined average of 30 percent or more to continue in the hiring process. Only those candidates successfully completing the initial interview and the fitness test shall be eligible to move onto a background investigation.

F. **Initial Background Investigation:** The Training Sergeant shall assign the Backgrounds- Account Clerk to complete the initial pre-employment background investigation for sworn employees. The Background-Account Clerk shall conduct the background investigation adhering to the following procedures. Additional inquiries may be directed by the Sheriff, Chief Deputy, or Administrative Commander.

1. **Criminal History:** The Backgrounds-Account Clerk shall:

a) Obtain the applicant's criminal history including NCIC, NCIS, and local checks.
b) Obtain the individual's driver's license abstract.
c) Contact the individual's local law enforcement jurisdiction to obtain prior criminal history.

2. **Credit Report:** The Backgrounds-Account Clerk shall obtain a current credit report for the applicant.

G. **Training Sergeant**

1. **Report Number:** The Training Sergeant shall obtain a report number from Communications. This report number shall be used for all information reports regarding the background investigation. Information reports shall be completed for each stage of the background investigation. All information shall be maintained in a background investigation file.

2. The Training Sergeant will put together a background investigation folder and assign the applicants folder to a sworn background investigator. This folder will contain but not limited to:

a) Photo of applicant
b) Initial Interview questions and applicant answers
c) Applicant Personal History Statement
d) Any additional applicant provided documents
e) Applicant's criminal history including NCIC, NCIS, and local checks
f) Applicant's driver's license abstract
g) Credit report
h) LRMS/Pro Phoenix entries
i) Nebraska Criminal Justice Information System entries

H. Background Investigation Completed by Deputy:

1. Employment References: The assigned sworn background investigator shall gather information on all past and present employment references including the following:

a) Dates of employment.
b) Position Held.
c) Circumstances surrounding resignation/termination.
d) Eligibility for rehire.

2. Personal References: The assigned sworn background investigator shall gather information on all personal references including the following:

a) How long the reference has known the applicant and in what capacity.
b) Describe the applicant's general reputation among his/her family and friends.
c) The applicant strengths and weaknesses.
d) Has the applicant had a relationship with a significant other of an abusive nature?
e) Does the reference have any concerns about this applicant working in law enforcement?
f) Do any other references know the applicant?

3. In-Home Interview: The background investigator shall arrange for a sworn employee to interview the applicant at his or her residence to:

a) Resolve any issues concerning the application.
b) Have the applicant complete Sheriff's Office questionnaire.
c) Provide information regarding the Sheriff's Office and required training.
d) Additional References**:** The background investigator completing the in-home interview shall attempt to contact neighborhood and employment references not listed on the application. Contact should be made in person, if possible.

I. **Polygraph Examination:** The applicant shall undergo a polygraph examination. The polygraph investigator shall be responsible for scheduling the date and time to complete the examination. The polygraph examination report shall be included in the background investigation file.

J. **Command Staff Interview:** Once all investigative steps are completed, applicants will be eligible to interview with the Chief Deputy and Division Commanders or his or her designee. This will be a benchmarked scored interview which will be combined with previous scores to create a final ranked applicant list.

K. **Sheriff's Interview:** Upon the final ranked applicant list certification by the Merit Commission, applicants are eligible for an interview with the Sheriff for the final hiring decision. The investigating deputy may be called upon to conduct further investigation after the interview as directed by the Sheriff.

L. **Psychological Evaluation:** After a conditional offer of employment is made by the Sheriff, the applicant shall be scheduled to complete a psychological evaluation. A copy of the results, which include a rating of the predicted risk the applicant poses if hired, shall be included in the background investigation file.

M. **Medical Examination:** After a conditional offer of employment is made by the Sheriff, the applicant shall be scheduled to complete a medical examination.

IV. **Non-Sworn Applicants:** The Sheriff's Office is responsible for completing background investigations on Non-Sworn Sheriff's Office employees, county employees and civilians, when requested. Unless specific requests have been made, the extent of the background completed shall be determined by the Professional Standard Division (see Background Levels below).

BACKGROUND LEVELS

Level 1

- ☐ Sarpy County Criminal History
- ☐ Douglas County Criminal History
- ☐ NCIC (National Criminal History)
- ☐ NCJIS (State)
- ☐ Credit Report
- ☐ DD214- (If applicable)
- ☐ Education References
- ☐ Personal References
- ☐ Employment History
- ☐ Polygraph
- ☐ In Home Interview

Level 2

- ☐ Sarpy County Criminal History
- ☐ Douglas County Criminal History
- ☐ NCIC (National Criminal History)
- ☐ NCJIS (State)
- ☐ Credit Report
- ☐ DD214- (If applicable)
- ☐ Education References
- ☐ Personal References
- ☐ Employment History
- ☐ Polygraph

Level 3

- ☐ Sarpy County Criminal History
- ☐ Douglas County Criminal History
- ☐ NCIC (National Criminal History)
- ☐ NCJIS (State)
- ☐ Credit Report

Level 4

- ☐ Sarpy County Criminal History
- ☐ Douglas County Criminal History
- ☐ NCIC (National Criminal History)
- ☐ NCJIS (State)

Level 5

- ☐ Sarpy County Criminal History
- ☐ Douglas County Criminal History
- ☐ NCIC (National Criminal History) including QNP.
- ☐ NCJIS (State)

Level 6

- ☐ NCIC (National Criminal History)

Level 7

- ☐ Sarpy County Criminal History

APPLICANT LEVEL

Level 1

Sheriff Sworn
Dispatcher's
Nurses

Level 2

Sheriff Non-Sworn
ESO's
JJC Employees /JJC Nurses
Cooks

Level 3

County Personnel
(Courthouse employees, maintenance, fleet services)

Level 4

Clergy
Volunteers/Interns
JJC FT Teachers
JJC PT Teachers
Ride Along Participants

Level 5

Gun Permits

Level 6

Red Light Permits
Sex Offenders

Level 7

Military Recruits
OPM (Office of Personnel Management)
Personal Background requests